

Getting Started with Corda

Corda is a distributed ledger technology first developed with businesses in mind. This step-by-step guide will get you started on it.

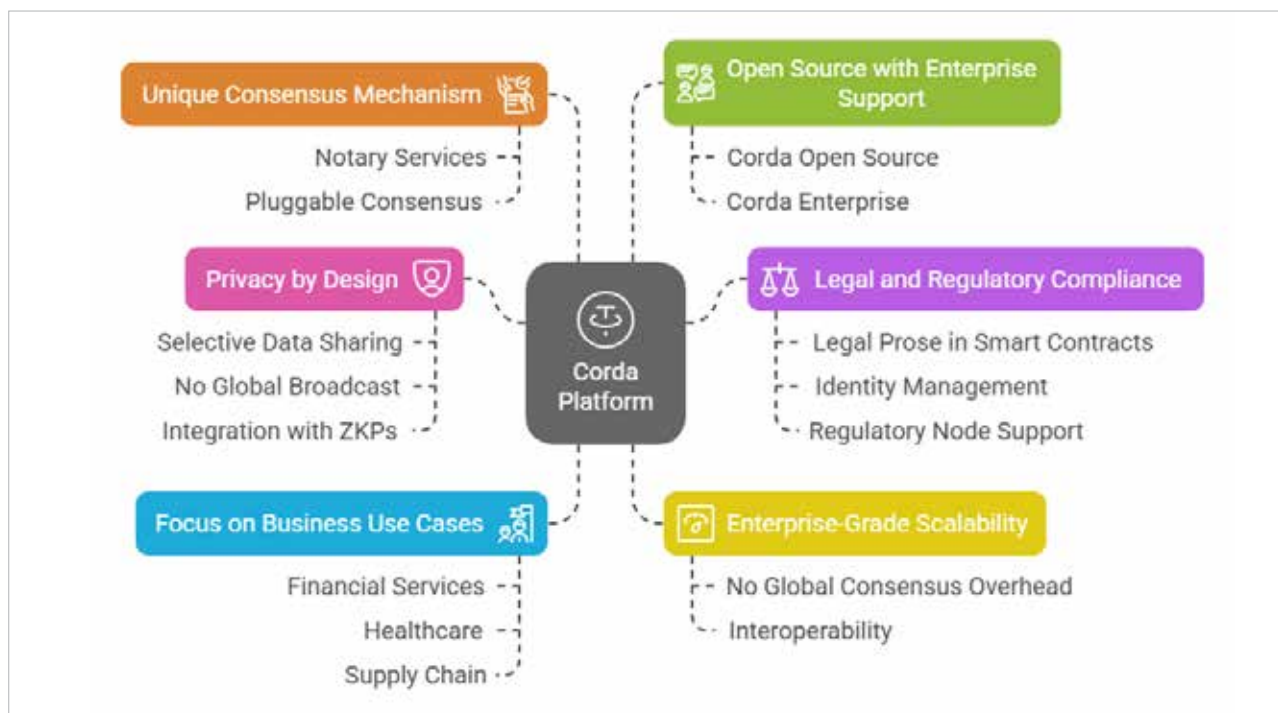


Figure 1: Corda features

Corda is a distributed ledger technology (DLT) designed for business applications, particularly in financial services. To construct interoperable blockchain networks that conduct transactions in complete secrecy, Corda is your only option. Businesses can engage in direct, valuable transactions with the help of Corda's smart contract technology.

Here's a step-by-step guide to get you started.

Step 1: Prerequisites

Before diving into Corda, ensure you have the following.

- **Java 8 or later:** Corda is built on Java, so make sure it's installed and properly configured.
- **IDE:** Any Java IDE like IntelliJ

IDEA or Eclipse will work. IntelliJ IDEA is the most recommended because it has good support for Kotlin, which Corda uses extensively.

- **Corda tools:** You'll also need to install the Corda command line interface (CLI) and Docker for running Corda nodes.

Step 2: Install Java and set up environment

Install Java:

- Download and install Java 8 or higher from Oracle's website or use OpenJDK.
- Set the `JAVA_HOME` environment variable to the installed Java path.

Verify Java installation by running:

```
java -version
```

Install Kotlin (optional, but helpful for Corda development): Corda is built with Kotlin, so having Kotlin set up in your IDE can help. You can download Kotlin from <https://kotlinlang.org/>

Step 3: Install IntelliJ IDEA

- Download and install IntelliJ IDEA Community Edition from <https://www.jetbrains.com/idea/download/?section=windows>
- Install the Corda plugin in IntelliJ. This plugin will help you set up and manage Corda projects easily.

Step 4: Download and set up Corda

Corda has several versions, including 'Corda Open Source' and 'Corda Enterprise'. You can start with Corda